communicative (in fact, Modi would use the black-and-white lotus symbol as a lapel on his kurta in all public interactions from 7 April 2014, the first day of polling, if only to reinforce the party's logo in the eyes of potential voters).

Modi has always liked technology as much as he likes wearing designer kurtas. He had started his website back in 2002 when few politicians even glanced at the Internet. An old Modi associate recalls how the seasoned politician was almost childlike when he was gifted an electronic diary once. 'He just likes to play around with some new tech device. He may not have the time to learn it always, but he just likes to be seen with it,' is how the friend describes Modi's tech-savvy avatar.

Modi was also aware of what was being tweeted about him. Once during a phone conversation, he suddenly said, *'Arre, tum aur tumhari biwi aaj kal bahut Twitter pe ho!'* (You and your wife are on Twitter a lot). Sagarika had just tweeted about how Modi should have acknowledged his wife Jasodhaben much earlier. Without mentioning the specific tweet, Modi had sent out the message he wanted to.

Even if Modi didn't look closely at his tweets, his team and followers certainly did. If the Gandhi family had their political chamchas, Modi had his 'Internet Hindus' (or bhakts, as I called them). I often found myself facing the ire of what appeared as an organized, systematic campaign of hate and abuse against anyone who didn't follow the prescribed narrative. Their social media profile usually was 'Proud Hindu nationalist. Want Namo for PM.' Internet Hindus are highly organized and motivated, and demolishing the narratives and reputations of mainstream media practitioners is their avowed objective.

My worst moment with this group came when I tweeted, 'While NaMo travels the country, my Nemo needs to be taken for a walk in the park. Different folks, different priorities!' It was an innocuous, if perhaps ill-advised attempt at wordplay—my beagle Nemo had been named after my daughter Tarini's favourite movie, *Finding Nemo*. The bhakts were unimpressed and let off a volley of abuse on social media. A few hours